



I'm a 16 year old person living in Denmark. I'm born in Denmark, but my parents are from Kyrgyzstan. I just finished primary school in Denmark and am now considering what my next step should be. I'm fluent in danish.
What educational path would you recommend for me?

Thanks for sharing your background—it's great that you're thinking carefully about your next step. Since you've just finished primary school in Denmark (which typically ends around 9th or 10th grade depending on your school), you now have several educational paths available through the Danish education system. Your choice depends on your interests, strengths, and future goals. Here's a breakdown of the main options:

1. Gymnasiale Uddannelser (General Upper Secondary Education)

These are academically focused and prepare you for university.

a) STX (Studentereksamen)

- Broad academic focus: humanities, sciences, social sciences.
- Good if you're not sure yet what you want to study later.
- Lasts 3 years.
- Strong pathway to university or college.

b) HHX (Higher Commercial Examination Programme)

- Focus on business, economics, marketing, and international trade.
- Good if you're interested in business or economics.
- Also 3 years and gives access to higher education.

c) HTX (Higher Technical Examination Programme)

- Focus on science, technology, and IT.
- Perfect if you're into engineering, science, or tech.
- 3 years as well, and leads to technical or university studies.

d) HF (Higher Preparatory Examination Programme)

- 2 years, slightly more practical and shorter than the others.
- Good if you want to enter specific professional courses (e.g. teacher, nurse, social worker).
- More mature environment; some students join after a break or with special needs.

2. Erhvervsuddannelser (Vocational Education and Training - EUD)

These combine school and apprenticeships in a company.

- Ideal if you want to **learn a trade** and start working sooner.
- Fields include carpentry, hairdressing, mechanics, health care, cooking, IT support, etc.
- Often takes 3–5 years depending on the trade.
- You earn money during your apprenticeship phase.
- You can still move on to further education afterward (e.g. via **EUX**—see below).

3. **EUX (Combined Vocational and General Upper Secondary)**

- A mix of vocational education **and** academic subjects.
- Takes longer (usually 4–5 years), but gives you both a trade and the right to apply for university.
- Best if you want practical experience but still want the **option** of higher education later.

What You Should Consider:

- **What subjects do you enjoy the most?** Math, languages, science, practical skills?
- **Do you prefer theoretical or practical learning?**
- **Would you like to study at university later, or start working sooner?**
- **Are you interested in business, science, trades, health, or tech?**

Example Scenarios:

Interest/Goal	Suggested Path
"I love science and maybe want to be an engineer."	HTX or STX with science focus
"I want to work with people or become a nurse or teacher."	HF or STX
"I want to start earning money and learn a practical skill."	EUD (e.g. in health, trades, IT)
"I'm interested in business or starting my own company."	HHX or EUX Business
"I want a mix of practical and academic education."	EUX (any track)

If you're not sure yet, that's completely normal. Many Danish students try out something and change later—it's flexible. You can also talk to a **UU-vejleder (youth guidance counselor)** at your school or municipality, who can help you explore options, including open house events or internships ("praktik").

If you'd like, you can tell me more about what you're interested in (subjects you like, hobbies, career dreams), and I can give more specific advice.